

Figure 2.7 *Ghor Province, Male Alau, brick tower, ruin, distant view. © Photograph Josephine Powell c. 1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

height, but any regional correlations or chronological indicators have as yet to be established. Although baked bricks were present, they were never documented *in situ*, but rather scattered nearby, and may have been used sparingly for decoration or perhaps now collapsed parts of structures. Wood seemed to play virtually no role in the construction.[39]

All structures tended to be up to three stories tall (Figure 2.10); many of the towers as well as larger complexes, consisted of superimposed rooms within a tower, or a small number of spaces within an enclosure. They hinted at short- or long-term habitation, with some of the interiors of upper rooms bearing traces of possible painted decoration, indicating that they could have been the living quarters; however, the date range of these decorations remains unknown. These possibly residential rooms were raised above lower ones that could have been used for storage, or perhaps shelter for livestock.[40] Since excavations have not been carried out at any of these locations, and only surface surveys with photographic documentation and schematic drawings are available, the patterns of usage remain conjectural.